Smokies Trip Overview

5-day trip · Smoky Mountain Christmas season · mountain times are Eastern

Trip Day 1 — Travel up

- Drive up from home with stops
- Dry weather; lows in the mid-30s °F overnight

Trip Day 2 — Dollywood Park Day 1 — see Dollywood itinerary PDF

Trip Day 3 — Smokies drive + Stampede

- Drive through Gatlinburg onto Newfound Gap Rd
- Picnic lunch at Chimney Tops Picnic Area
- Optional scenic drive toward Newfound Gap
- National park parking tag needed for stops over 15 min (buy online or at a visitor center)
- Sunset ~5:30 PM; cold at elevation, so bring layers
- Rest in the afternoon
- 8:30 PM Dixie Stampede, Pigeon Forge (ends ~10 PM; lap children under 3 free)

Trip Day 4 — Dollywood Park Day 2 — see Dollywood itinerary PDF

Trip Day 5 — Travel home

- Check out and head home mid-morning

Checklist

- Dollywood tickets for both park days
- Stampede seats for the 8:30 show
- Park scooter reservation at least 48 hours ahead, if needed
- National park parking tag for the Smokies drive